

Enabling TV advertisement interactivity, at last, with SIMID

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Introduction

Developed and standardized by IAB, SIMID (Secure Interactive Media Interface Definition) [4] provides a framework for seamless interactivity in streaming video ads. In this talk, we will first present the concepts and fundamentals of the SIMID framework with respect to its predecessor VPAID [2] and how it works under the hood. We will focus on how SIMID enables rich interactive formats especially in the context of Server-Side Ad Insertion (SSAI). Finally, we will present a new open-source initiative to provide a SIMID SDK containing basic components implementation to aid in the integration of the SIMID framework.

SIMID and interactivity in an SSAI Context

SSAI ensures seamless video delivery but traditionally prevents interactivity, since ads are stitched server-side as linear assets. This removes the hooks needed for clickable or dynamic ad elements. SIMID addresses this limitation by delivering interactivity through a separate creative layer, executed in a sandbox (iframe or WebView) alongside the SSAI video stream. The creative communicates with the player exclusively via standardized SIMID messages, reporting events such as clicks, resize requests, or user interactions.

Experiment. The latest version of the SIMID protocol [3] is provided by the IAB together with an open-source project that aims to provide some demonstration samples and an implementation starter guide. Our goal was first to deploy these components, integrate them into a simple web environment, and highlight the message-based communication model that differentiates SIMID from VPAID. Then we went deeper into SIMID functionalities and notably its ability to handle non-linear and interactive creatives such as banners (Figure 1), all orchestrated in an SSAI workflow.

We developed some demonstrator to implement the resizing functionality to enable any creative to control the player video dimensions and display advertising banners without overlaying the main stitched video content. Finally, we implemented such banners to be interactive, customizing the creative to include a clickable banner with interactive controls that can update the creative's UI while simultaneously tracking user actions. These experiments demonstrated the ability of SIMID to allow SSAI workflows to retain their scalability and resilience while restoring interactive advertising capabilities.

The SIMID SDK open-source initiative

Companies aiming to integrate SIMID into their applications or custom players require a stable, reusable, and well-documented codebase that abstracts the complexity of the protocol. To meet this need, we developed an open source SDK that provides a ready-to-use foundation for SIMID adoption on different platforms (Web, Android). The SIMID controller SDK [1] is structured as follows for both the Web and Android platforms:

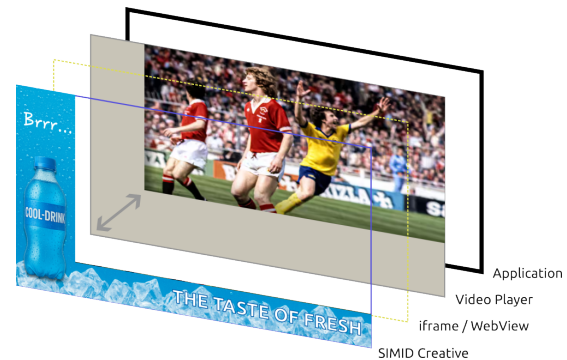


Figure 1: The SIMID conceptual model

- **SIMID Controller:** a core module that runs in the player environment, handling all SIMID message exchanges, lifecycle events, player resizing, and interactive actions. It acts as the central interface between the player and SIMID creatives.
- **Demonstration Application:** a sample application that shows practical implementations, using web iframe and android WebView, including non-linear interactive ads, resizing behavior, and creative-player interactions.

The SIMID controller is a companion module and agnostic to the player, and can therefore be integrated alongside any player such as open-source players (dash.js, Shaka Player, hls.js, exoplayer, etc). While this SDK requires dedicated integration work within applications, it can be leveraged across any ad insertion technology without requiring an all-in-one ad insertion SDK.

By providing this open source SDK and accompanying demonstration applications, our goal is to lower the entry barrier for publishers, advertisers, and technology providers to adopt the SIMID framework.

REFERENCES

- [1] Broadpeak. 2025. *SIMID controller github project*. <https://github.com/Broadpeak-tv/simid-controller>
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